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NBA

Heat 'not accomplishing one thing'

By CHRIS PERKINS
Heat beat the Heat

MIAMI — For the second consecutive year the Heat training camp is resulting in a big hit story.

"We're not accomplishing one thing," coach Erik Riley said after Saturday night's 85-70 loss to Charlotte.

"It's maybe that's a slight bit of hyperbole, but things are bad. The 14 Heat have three losses of 10 or more points, the best exhibition game showing has been a 106-100 overtime loss against a suspect Miami Heat team.

The veterans have been too injured to contribute, consistently. The young players have been disappointing. In that respect, camp seems to be raising questions instead of answering them.

Among the players most likely to be in the Heat's veteran rotation — guards Dwyane Wade, Jason Williams and Small Forward, forwards Udonis Haslem, David Wright and Antonio Walker and centers Shaquille O'Neal and Alonzo Mourning — no one has been in every practice and game.

Beyond that, Riley has no idea who'll play shooting guard for the No. 1 seed

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son speaker against Detroit.

While recovering from offseason knee and shoulder surgeries, won't be healthy. The top candidates to fill in (Parker, Jeremy Richardson, Devin Green and Travy Hardaway) have ranged from no-show to awful.

"It could be a couple of point guards (Williams and Parker) playing together that just feel confident about playing a game, versus a young kid (Richardson) that feels like he's got to make it," Riley said. "We've got a lot of talent there, but right now, it's not showing much."

Riley also isn't sure who will start at small forward between Wright and Walker. Wright has been almost injury-free, except when getting in bad trouble. Walker, called out by Riley for being over his body fat limit, is better suited for power forward.

The league requires you to have five guys on the court, so that night we'll put

somebody out there," Riley said of his "open-minded" strategy.

The Heat, which had back-to-back losses to Dallas and Charlotte this weekend, had Sunday off. That should help O'Neal, who left Saturday's loss with a bruised left thigh.

But with the season opener a little more than two weeks away things already have reached the critical stage: Most NBA teams have put something close to an opening night starting lineup on the court. Not Miami.

O'Neal already had missed a few practices because of tendinitis in his left knee. And he's likely to miss more this week with the bruise. That means the offense makes no progress.

"We can practice a lot of pick and roll and different things," Haslem said, but when Big Ben comes in the game we want to get the ball inside. It's kind of throwing off everything we practice."

Heat's head coach Erik Riley said, "We've got to get things done. At one point Saturday the Heat lineup was guards Brian Chase, Green and Richardson, forward Marcus Slaughter and center Earl Barron.

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THE ARCADE

Compiled from staff and wire reports



After all that, I deserve a drink

KALUAKUNA, Hawaii — Chris McCormack celebrates his victory late Saturday in the Inouye World Championship, in which participants complete a 2.4-mile swim, a 12-mile hike and a marathon. Four area triathletes completed the race within 12-hour time limit. **Heat, 1:04:30**

TEST YOUR WITS

Who am I?

I was a former Detroit Pistons assistant who was named the first head coach of the Miami Heat in July 1988.

Match game

Link the Miami Heat first-round pick to his college team.

1. Mike Butler, 1990
2. Carlos Butler, 2002
3. Tim James, 1999
4. Howard Miller, 1992
5. Glen Rice, 1988
6. Roy Stryker, 1988
7. Steve Smith, 1991
8. Kurt Thomas, 1995
9. Kevin White, 1995
10. Steve Nisley, 1995

WEB POLL

Does Dolphins quarterback Cleo Lemon deserve another start?
A. Yes, B. No
PalmBeachPost.com and click on sports.
Sunday's poll: Who will win Saturday's game between Miami and Florida State?
Miami, 48 percent; FSU, 52 percent.

RANTS AND RAVES

Rant: Kelvin Sampson

The Indiana men's basketball coach is in trouble again with his employer, and could be in trouble with the NCAA. Sampson will have a \$500,000 bonus this year, and a scholarship next year for not following an NCAA ban on contacting recruits.

Rave: Leading by example

Homecoming king candidate at Lake Forest (Mich.) High this month gave the crowd to sophomore Eli Florence, 25, who was suffering from incurable leukemia. Sunday night after Eli's coronation, he died at home. The well-known act of the senior — football players David Dantreng, Mike Kelly, Lucas Manistrato and Matthew Janszwill and golfer Ethan Merivort — did more for their community than anything they could ever do on the field.

ANSWERS

Who was 17 Ron Babin, who had a 15-6 record in the Heat's first season.
Randy game: 1-A, 3-B, 3-C, 4-C, 5-A, 6-B, 7-A, 8-A.

MORNING COFFEE CHATTER

Now that's an extreme fish tale

After Bruce and his friends figured they'd land some property while participating in the Destin Fishing Rodeo on Saturday morning, an 11-foot, 844.4-pound mako shark changed their plans.

"It was true," Bruce, 46, said about the harpoon fight to land the shark. "The fisher had about 20 miles southwest of Destin. They couldn't get the shark into the boat so they tied it to the stern with three ropes for the four-hour trip back to port."

It was like "Jaws," captain Robert Hill said.

ON THE AIR

Best bet: Red Sox at Indians

7 p.m. Cleveland has a great opportunity to take the ALCS lead in front of its home crowd after scoring a huge win early Sunday in extra innings.

Television	
BASEBALL	
7 p.m.	Red Sox at Indians
10:15 p.m.	Diamondbacks at Rockies
COLLEGE SOCCER	
8 p.m.	Wham!; Michigan State at Ohio State
NFL	
8:30 p.m.	Giants at Falcons
NHL	
7 p.m.	Maple Leafs at Sabres

Provisional channels such as ESPN, ESPN Classic, the Sports Illustrated Channel, the Soccer Channel and Versus will not broadcast these events systemically. Check your listings to call your cable or satellite provider.

ON RADIO	TIME	Indians at Red Sox	Site
7:30 p.m.	Indians at Red Sox	Ind	

Area events		
DOG RACING		
12:40 p.m.	Palm Beach Kennel Club	(561) 881-1111
HORSE RACING		

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